

Hail and Storm Damage Roof Claim Checklist

For Dallas-Fort Worth homeowners. What to do in the first hours, days and weeks after hail or wind damages your roof.

1. Right after the storm

- ☐ Stay clear of downed power lines and call 911 and your electric provider.
- ☐ Keep people out of rooms where the ceiling is wet or sagging.
- ☐ Stay off the roof. Wet, damaged roofs are slick and can have weak decking.
- ☐ Write down the date and time of the storm, and the size of the hail if you saw it (pea, quarter, golf ball).

2. Document the damage

- ☐ Photograph the roof from the ground on every side, wide shots and zoomed in.
- ☐ Photograph dented gutters, downspouts, roof vents, AC unit fins, window screens, fences and cars. They show hail size and help prove the storm hit your house.
- ☐ Photograph shingles, granules or debris in the yard and at the downspouts.
- ☐ Photograph every ceiling stain, drip and wet spot inside, with the date.
- ☐ Keep a simple log: what you saw, when, and who you spoke with.

3. Stop more damage

- ☐ Put buckets under drips and move belongings out of the way.
- ☐ If the roof is open, have a roofer install an emergency tarp. Most policies expect reasonable steps to prevent further damage.
- ☐ Keep every receipt for emergency repairs, tarps and supplies. They are usually part of the claim.

4. Read your policy before you file

- ☐ Find your wind and hail deductible. In Texas it is often a percentage of your home's insured value, not a flat dollar amount.
- ☐ Check whether the roof is paid at replacement cost or actual cash value.
- ☐ Look for the deadline to report storm damage, and report promptly.
- ☐ On the coast, check whether wind is covered by your homeowners policy or a separate windstorm policy.

5. File the claim

- ☐ Call your insurance company or file online, and write down your claim number.
- ☐ Have a roofer inspect the roof and document the damage before the adjuster visits.
- ☐ Ask the roofer to be on the roof when the adjuster comes, to point out the damage.
- ☐ Get the adjuster's estimate in writing and compare it with the roofer's.

6. Hire carefully

- ☐ Texas does not issue a state license for roofers. Ask for proof of insurance, a local address and references from nearby jobs.
- ☐ Get the scope, the shingle brand and line, the price, the timeline and the workmanship warranty in writing before work starts.
- ☐ Do not pay most of the price upfront.
- ☐ **Under Texas law, a contractor may not pay, waive or rebate your insurance deductible.** Treat any offer to do so as a red flag.
- ☐ The claim is between you and your insurer. A roofer can document damage and meet the adjuster, but should not negotiate the claim on your behalf.
- ☐ Read any agreement a door-to-door roofer asks you to sign after a storm before you sign it, and never sign on the spot under pressure.

7. After the work is done

- ☐ Get the final invoice, the permit and inspection paperwork where your city requires them, and the manufacturer and workmanship warranties.
- ☐ Take photos of the finished roof.
- ☐ If your policy held back part of the payment (recoverable depreciation), send the insurer the paperwork it asks for to release it.
- ☐ If you are replacing the roof, ask your insurer whether impact-resistant (Class 4) shingles earn a premium discount.

Need an inspection? Call **(469) 649-7066** any time and you will be put through to a local, owner-run roofing company. Dallas Roofing Pro is a referral service; the roofing company you are connected with inspects, quotes and does the work.

This checklist is general information, not legal or insurance advice. Policies differ; your policy and your insurer have the final word.